

MARINER 10

Space probe

Mariner 10 flew to within **327 km (203 miles)** of Mercury's surface.

Solar panel

Television cameras



Venus as seen by Mariner 10

Sunshade protected the instruments from the Sun's intense heat

Mariner 10 was the first space probe to visit the two innermost planets: Venus and Mercury. It passed Mercury three times, discovering an airless world covered in impact craters – shrunk and shrivelled like an old apple. The probe studied Venus's atmosphere, looking at its composition and circulation around the planet.

DATA FILE



SIZE: 8 m (26.2 ft) long



DATE OF LAUNCH: 3 November 1973



MISSION DURATION: 1 year, 4 months, 12 days (deactivated)



SPACE AGENCY: NASA